the members of the BRICS. Taking note of alternative conceptualizations of interstate "power," the chapter maps the redistribution of economic capabilities from the G7 to the BRICS, most particularly the relative rise of China and decline of Japan, and especially of Europe. Given these clear trends in measurable material capabilities, the BRICS have obtained considerable autonomy from outside pressures. Although the BRICS' economic, financial, and monetary capabilities remain uneven, their relative positions have improved steadily. Via extensive data analysis, the chapter argues that whether one examines China alone or the BRICS as a group, the BRICS members have developed the necessary capabilities to challenge the global economic and financial leadership of the currently dominant powers —and perhaps even the United States one day. At the same time, the inertia and incumbency of continuing American structural power perpetuate the existing global financial order and the U.S. dollar.

Chapter 3 examines four cases in which the BRICS governments engaged in collective financial statecraft between 2007 and mid-2016. The first type is inside reforms of existing institutions, illustrated by the BRICS' attempt to gain greater influence within the IMF and World Bank. A second type is inside reforms of the political power accruing to states that possess currency power and whose firms dominate global markets. The associated case profiles the BRICS' opposition to sanctions against Russia over its intervention in Ukraine. A third type of BRICS collective action occurs via the outside option to create new parallel institutions such as the NDB and CRA. Finally, the fourth type combines the choice of an outside option with a market-based venue, such as BRICS support for greater internationalization of China's currency to rival the U.S. dollar. The BRICS have cooperated successfully in most of their attempts.

Chapter 4 explores the distinct mix of motives within each country's foreign policy goals that has impelled cooperation among the five BRICS countries. In the case of China, the BRICS club allows it to express its leaders' aversion to Western high-handedness and policy demands, while exerting leadership in a less threatening fashion. Russia prioritizes resistance to financial sanctions and Western dominance, while aiming to translate BRICS cooperation into greater regional and global influence. India hopes to amplify its voice in global governance and to expand choices of international partners through the BRICS. Brazil's left-leaning governments through mid-2016 hoped to emphasize South-South